



The President of the University of Liberia Commends the Progress at UL Soil Laboratory

The President of the University of Liberia (UL), Dr. Layli Maparyan, has commended the significant progress being made at the University's Soil Laboratory under the European Union-funded Liberia Land and Soil Resources Knowledge Project (Soils4Liberia) implemented by the International Institute of Tropical Agriculture (IITA) in collaboration with national and international partners. Dr. Maparyan made the remarks on August 6, 2026, during her visit to the UL Soil Lab, where she interacted with UL technicians and IITA technical training facilitators.

technical capacity and positioning it to play a greater role in soil, plant and water research and analysis in Liberia.

The nine-day training, organized by IITA, brought together UL Soil laboratory technicians and IITA experts drawn from Nigeria and Cameroon. The visiting technical experts, along with the Soils4Liberia Project Soil Scientist facilitated the training.



Dr. Shiferaw Abebe Dakka,
Soils4Liberia Project, providing an
update to the visit

The continued collaboration between IITA, the University of Liberia, the Ministry of Agriculture, and other national and international technical partners demonstrates the value of sustained institutional partnerships in building national scientific capacity and strengthening Liberia's systems for soil information and agricultural development.



Dr. Layli Maparyan paying visit to the Atomic Absorption Spectrometer (AAS) in the UL soil Lab

During the visit, the UL President received an update on the past and ongoing capacity-building activities, toured the laboratory, and observed technicians engaged in practical soil analysis procedures. She thanked IITA for lab facility transformation underway to strengthen the lab's



IITA Strengthens UL Soil Laboratory Capacity Through Technical Training



UL Soil Laboratory Technician Monica A. Young, conducts a soil analysis during the Soils4Liberia technical training.

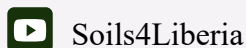
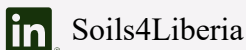
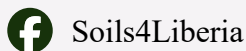
The International Institute of Tropical Agriculture (IITA) is strengthening Liberia's capacity to generate reliable soil data and information through an intensive technical training program for laboratory technicians at the University of Liberia (UL) Soil Testing, Plant and Water Analysis Laboratory.

The second technical training, organized under the European Union-funded Liberia Land and Soil Resources Knowledge Project (Soils4Liberia), brought together soil laboratory experts from IITA's Analytical Services Laboratory in Ibadan, Nigeria, and technical experts from IITA Cameroon to provide hands-on training and technical support to the UL Soil Laboratory.

The training, held from August 3 - 12, 2026, was facilitated by a team of lab experts headed by Mr. Joseph Uponi from IITA Analytical Services

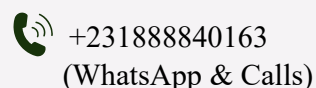
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Mr. Joseph Uponi demonstrating procedure during the technical training at UL Soil Laboratory

Laboratory in Ibadan, Nigeria. Two visiting soil laboratory specialists from IITA Cameroon, Jean Baptiste Biloa and Elton Eteckji Fonkeng, participated in the training activities, reinforcing IITA's regional approach to strengthening scientific and laboratory capacity across Africa, further supported the technical team.

The training focused on strengthening the practical competencies of UL Soil Laboratory technicians in handling and processing soil samples, physical and chemical and analysis. Sessions covered sample registration, processing, , packaging and storage, preparation of soil analysis solutions, , lab equipment calibration and maintenance, and other essential laboratory practices. The practical nature of the training allowed technicians to apply the procedures directly within the laboratory, while receiving guidance from experienced IITA laboratory experts.



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